

Name

Index Number

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

West African Senior School Certificate Examination
for School Candidates

SC 2026

SOCIAL STUDIES 1
OBJECTIVE TEST

50 minutes

Do **not** open this booklet until you are told to do so. While you are waiting, read and observe the following instructions. Write your **name** and **index number** in the spaces provided above.

1. Use **2B** pencil throughout.
2. On the pre-printed answer sheet, check that the following details are **correctly** printed:
 - (a) In the space marked **Name**, check your **surname** followed by your **other names**.
 - (b) In the spaces marked *Examination*, *Year*, *Subject* and *Paper*, check 'WASSCE (SC)', '2026', 'SOCIAL STUDIES', and '1' respectively.
 - (c) In the box marked *Index Number*, your **index number** has been printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side, and **each** numbered space has been shaded in line with **each** digit. **Reshade** each of the shaded spaces.
 - (d) In the box marked *Subject Code*, the digits 226112 are printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side. **Reshade** the corresponding numbered spaces as you did for your index number.
3. An example is given below. This is for a male candidate whose name is Tony Mensah ATIAH. His *index number* is 7102143958 and he is offering *Social Studies* 1.

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
ANSWER SHEET

PRINT IN BLOCK LETTERS	
Name: ATIAH TONY MENSAH	GHA
Examination: WASSCE (SC)	Year: 2026
Subject: SOCIAL STUDIES	Paper: 1

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Use grade 2B pencil throughout.
2. Answer each question by choosing one letter and shading like this: ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
3. Erase completely any answer you wish to change.
4. Leave extra spaces blank if the answer spaces provided are more than you need.
5. Do not make any markings across the heavy black marks at the right hand edge of your answer sheet.

INDEX NUMBER										SUBJECT CODE											
7	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
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4	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	For Supervisors only If candidate is absent shade this space ☐										
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5	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											
8	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9											

Answer **all** the questions.

Each question is followed by **four** options lettered **A** to **D**. Find the **correct** option for **each** question. Shade in **pencil** on your answer sheet the answer space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen. Give only **one** answer to **each** question. An example is given below.

The administrative head of a public corporation is the

- A. speaker.
- B. managing director.
- C. director-general.
- D. chairman.

The correct answer is **managing director** which is lettered **B**, and therefore answer space **B** would be shaded.

☐ A ☒ B ☐ C ☐ D

Think carefully before you shade the answer spaces; erase completely any answer you wish to change.

Do **all** rough work in this question paper.

Now answer the following questions.

1. Which agency has the **primary** responsibility of enforcing traffic regulations in Ghana?
 - A. Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA)
 - B. Ghana Highway Authority (GHA)
 - C. Motor Traffic and Transport Department (MTTD)
 - D. National Road Safety Authority (NRSA)
2. What term is used to describe measures designed to prevent road accidents?
 - A. Road marking
 - B. Road safety
 - C. Road traffic
 - D. Road security
3. In Ghanaian society, various institutions are established to promote law and order. Which of the following institutions is mandated to enforce law?
 - A. Judicial service
 - B. Security service
 - C. Legislative assembly
 - D. The Ghana Bar Association
4. Colonialism impacted African societies in several ways. Which of the following options was a **positive** influence?
 - A. Cultural preservation efforts
 - B. Improved infrastructure system
 - C. Protection of natural resources
 - D. Tribal unity and cohesion
5. What ethical action should a student take after finding a wallet that does **not** belong to him/her?
 - A. Keep the money, return the ID cards
 - B. Keep it as a found item
 - C. Return it to authorities
 - D. Take reward before returning

6. Entrepreneurship contributes to personal development by
 - A. eliminating continuous learning.
 - B. ensuring financial insecurity.
 - C. fostering problem-solving skills.
 - D. removing all life challenges.
7. Indigenous transportation technologies benefited early African society by
 - A. enabling cultural isolation.
 - B. facilitating trade exchanges.
 - C. preventing foreign invasion.
 - D. reducing agricultural needs.
8. A lady applied for scholarship in Ghana but used another person's name and date of birth. What does the lady's action illustrates?
 - A. Engaging with familiar cultures
 - B. Hiding her real self
 - C. Living morally and sincerely
 - D. Seeking external opportunities
9. The **key** feature of the Scientific Revolution was
 - A. rejection of all traditional knowledge.
 - B. reliance on religious texts for explanation.
 - C. emphasis on empirical evidence.
 - D. focus on theoretical mathematics.
10. Why are constitutions in Ghana's legal system important? Because they
 - A. are suggestions rather than binding.
 - B. can easily be changed by government.
 - C. focus on national economic policies.
 - D. form the foundation for all other laws.
11. How does the patriotic song "Yen Ara Asaase Ni" contribute to promoting national cohesion? By
 - A. celebrating the country's heritage
 - B. criticizing foreign influence
 - C. focusing on military achievements
 - D. promoting one cultural tradition
12. A group of Ghanaians campaigned peacefully for improved health care services in their community. How does this advocacy contribute to Ghana's development? It
 - A. impacts government policy.
 - B. prevents government projects.
 - C. reduces public awareness.
 - D. restricts political emancipation.
13. What adaptation strategy did ancient African societies develop in response to the gradual desertification of the Sahara region?
 - A. Created systems for managing limited agricultural resources
 - B. Developed extensive trade networks across diverse regions
 - C. Engineered specialized settlements around water sources
 - D. Established migration patterns between ecological zones
14. Which policy of government helps to induce regional initiatives?
 - A. Centralizing resources in the capital for the benefit of all
 - B. Allocating resources for public-private partnership
 - C. Privatizing essential services in some regions
 - D. Decentralizing development projects

15. In Ghana's taxation system, luxury goods are subject to higher tax rates compared to basic necessities. What **primary** purpose of taxation does this policy **most** effectively serve?
- Controlling consumption pattern
 - Funding public infrastructure
 - Stabilizing the economy
 - Re-distributing wealth equitably
16. Which of the following options represents an opportunity in resisting false identity?
- Economic risk of authentic self-expression
 - Fear of rejection by peers or loved ones
 - Personal growth through self-discovery
 - Pressure to conform to societal norms
17. Why is environmental education important for sustainable development? It
- creates employment opportunities for environmental specialists.
 - ensures that people follow environmental laws out of fear.
 - focuses exclusively on scientific knowledge about the environment.
 - fosters widespread adoption of eco-friendly choices.
18. A police station in a rural area lacks vehicles, adequate staffing, and communication equipment. What challenge does this scenario illustrate in relation to law enforcement?
- Corruption and misconduct
 - Legal and regulatory
 - Political system interference
 - Operational resource limitation
19. How do fair and impartial trials **best** help address societal injustices in Ghana?
- Ensuring quick resolution of cases
 - Guaranteeing victory for the rich
 - Protecting fundamental rights
 - Restricting court cases
20. The President of Ghana has appointed ministers from different ethnic groups to serve in his cabinet, ensuring every region is represented. What approach to national cohesion is reflected in this scenario?
- Cultural exchange programmes
 - Inclusive education policies
 - Political reform initiatives
 - Economic integration measures
21. Some law enforcement agencies have often been accused of being corrupt in the discharge of their duties. Which of the following approaches would **most** effectively address the problem?
- Enforcing oversight policies
 - Relocating corrupt officers
 - Replacing officers with technology
 - Restricting public access
22. In an attempt to improve tax collection, the Government of Ghana is faced with challenges in tax implementation. What **major** challenge is the government **likely** to be facing?
- Excessive tax payer surveillance
 - Large non-taxable informal sector
 - Multiple tax collection agencies
 - High compliance rate

23. Why did the construction of Akosombo Dam become part of the Cold War politics? Because
- America wanted to counter Soviet influence in Ghana
 - Britain opposed Ghana's industrial development
 - Soviet Union wanted to control Ghana's electricity
 - United Nations required certain funding arrangements
24. Which component of entrepreneurial idea implementation focuses on how products will reach customers?
- Business concept
 - Advertisement
 - Product design
 - Marketing strategy
25. A university student in Accra creates a monthly budget but consistently exceeds his/her spending limits on entertainment. How does this **most** likely affect his/her financial goals?
- Accelerates her path to financial freedom
 - Delays progress toward savings objectives
 - Improves her credit score with financial institutions
 - Reduces his/her overall tax liability for the year
26. How would a person who does motor cycle delivery business sustain the business when fuel prices increase rampantly? By
- importing cheaper fuel from neighbouring countries
 - maintaining prices to cover additional expenditures
 - securing a government subsidy for the cost of fuel
 - switching to electric motor cycles
27. What is the **primary** purpose of creating a personal budget?
- Avoiding all forms of debt
 - Managing income and expenses
 - Maximizing investment returns
 - Reducing taxation liabilities
28. A community comprising Christians, Muslims, and Traditional believers collaborates to resolve conflicts through dialogue and shared religious activities. Which fundamental value of national cohesion does this exemplify?
- Hospitality initiatives
 - Implementation of common language
 - Cross-party political alliances
 - Respect for diversity
29. The **most** effective approach for improving relations between communities and law enforcement agencies in Ghana is by
- deploying more armed officers to patrol communities.
 - establishing community policing and advisory boards.
 - imposing stricter penalties for all criminal offences in the community.
 - promoting interactions between citizens and security personnel.
30. Kwame observes that his community's river has become polluted after mining activities begun upstream. He organizes community members to advocate for better mining practices. What kind of human-environment relationship is Kwame demonstrating?
- Accepting environmental degradation as inevitable
 - Developing a sense of responsibility toward the environment
 - Relying on government to solve environmental problem
 - Seeking alternative water sources for the community

31. The principle of Rule of Law implies that
- laws are created by traditional authorities.
 - no one is above the law, regardless of status.
 - only lawyers interpret legal provisions.
 - the president has the final say on legal matters.
32. Why is respect for elders considered a shared value across Ghanaian societies? Because the elders
- are custodians of wisdom and tradition.
 - have more financial resources to support others.
 - provide protection against external threats.
 - keep the resources of the community.
33. A female medical student feels pressured to continue her studies, despite having a passion for music, because her parents want her to become a medical doctor. What challenge does this scenario illustrate?
- Economic risks
 - Family expectation
 - Fear of rejection
 - Internalized belief
34. How was the 1966 coup in Ghana connected to the Cold War?
- It was planned by communist countries
 - Eastern bloc countries tried to foil the coup
 - Western concerns about the socialist directions of the country
 - Kwame Nkrumah had declared Ghana as a non-aligned country
35. A mining company has been discharging waste into a nearby river despite warnings from authorities. According to Ghana's environmental regulatory framework, which sequence of actions represents the solution to the problem?
- Environmental audit - community consultation - negotiated settlement
 - Immediate closure - court action - environment impact assessment
 - Public complaint - media coverage - traditional authority intervention- court action
 - Fine - suspension of environmental permit - prosecution
36. How can the environment be **best** secured against problems that threaten the survival of people?
- Avoiding poor sanitation practices
 - Discouraging mining activities near water bodies
 - Enforcing laws and regulations
 - Promoting safety activities
37. Road accidents in Ghana have increased in recent times as a result of reckless driving and poor signage. What strategy would **most** effectively improve road safety in the country?
- Banning commercial vehicles during rush hours
 - Focus on punishing and retribution of traffic offenders
 - Public awareness campaigns and enforcement of traffic laws
 - Reconstruction of roads in poor condition
38. Your community is experiencing serious physical environmental challenges. Which of the following measures will be **most** effective in addressing the situation in the community?
- Economic development projects
 - Ecosystem protection management
 - Natural resource conservation
 - Proper waste management

39. What was the **major** reason European powers increased their interest in Africa during the industrial revolution?
- Creating autonomous economies
 - Enhancing indigenous technologies
 - Guaranteeing supply of raw material
 - Transferring industrial knowledge
40. Which of the following situations **best** illustrates the concept of self-direction in entrepreneurship?
- Consulting with supervisors before making decisions
 - Following standard corporate procedures
 - Functioning within defined organizational tiers
 - Taking initiatives in setting work schedules
41. Ama has been overwhelmed with school and household responsibilities. She has, therefore decided to engage in sporting activities and listening to music during her free time. What are the **primary** mental health benefits Ama can derive from engaging in these leisure and recreational activities?
- Building muscle and physical strength
 - Improving financial literacy and investment skills
 - Reducing stress and depression
 - Deriving specific professional and academic qualification
42. Technology can **best** be leveraged to improve upon law enforcement in Ghana by
- replacing human officers with robots.
 - creating a surveillance state that monitors citizens.
 - implementing digital tools for crime data analysis.
 - restricting internet access to prevent online crimes.
43. The **most** effective approach in addressing the colonial legacy of dependence on foreign goods is
- abandoning all technological advancements.
 - exclusively using imported products.
 - promoting locally manufactured products.
 - rejecting international trade agreements.
44. In the 19th century, Europeans sought to establish colonies in Africa. Which of the following options was the **main** reason for the establishment of such colonies?
- Desire to fulfill humanitarian mission
 - Genuine concern for African development
 - National pride and status as imperial powers
 - Preference for African political system
45. Which of the following Acts provides a legal framework for citizens to seek redress when harmed by false online information?
- Broadcasting
 - Cybersecurity
 - Communication
 - Whistler blower
46. How does leisure and recreational activities **most** directly contribute to national development in Ghana? By
- decreasing the need for education and training
 - encouraging tribalism and ethnic divisions
 - improving productivity through refreshed workers
 - reducing the amount of work citizens need to do

47. How does the consumer's right to make a choice of a product benefit him/her?
- A. Allowing businesses to limit product availability
 - B. Encouraging consumers to increase their spending
 - C. Limiting market entry for new business
 - D. Selecting from various products at competitive prices
48. How would increase in the consumption of locally produced goods **most** directly benefit Ghana's economy? By
- A. boosting job creation while decreasing import levels
 - B. decreasing demand while increasing import levels
 - C. limiting consumer choices in the market places
 - D. raising prices for essential consumer goods
49. In Ghana, how can Value Added Tax paid by clients after purchasing an item be classified?
- A. Direct tax collected straight from the business
 - B. Indirect tax added to the prices of goods
 - C. Progressive tax that increases with income
 - D. Regressive tax on luxury products
50. A community has noticed a government agency is acting outside its legal mandate. Which judicial remedy would be **most** appropriate to stop this action?
- A. Certiorari
 - B. Damages
 - C. Mandamus
 - D. Prohibition

END OF PAPER

SC 2262
WASSCE 2026
SOCIAL STUDIES 2
Essay
2½ hours

2

CANDIDATE'S NAME	
INDEX NUMBER	SIGNATURE
DATE:	

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

West African Senior School Certificate Examination
for School Candidates

SC 2026

SOCIAL STUDIES 2
ESSAY

2½ hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- In the spaces provided above, insert your name, full index number, normal signature and the date of examination.*
- This booklet consists of three sections; A, B and C. Answer four questions in all, choosing at least one and not more than two questions from each section.
All questions carry equal marks.*
- Write the question number and your index number at the top of each page.*
- Write on both sides of the paper unless otherwise instructed on the question paper.*
- Begin each answer to a question on a fresh page. Leave two lines between answers where there are sub-questions to the same question.*
- On no account should you tear off any part of the booklet.
It is an examination malpractice to do so. The answer booklet will be collected at the end of the examination.*
- Write in the space provided below, the number of the questions you have answered in the order in which you have written them.*

For Examiner's Use Only	
Question Number	Mark
TOTAL	

Answer **four** questions in all, choosing at least **one** and **not more than two** questions from **each** section.

SECTION A

IDENTITY, SIGNIFICANCE AND PURPOSE AND ENVIRONMENT AND SUSTAINABILITY

1. Using your knowledge of migration, discuss **five** factors that influenced adaptations of early African populations in new settlements. [20 marks]
2. (a) Identify **four** causes of false identity. [4 marks]
(b) Supposing a young graduate used fake academic certificate to secure a job. Discuss **four** implications of the graduate's action for his/her personal development. [16 marks]
3. You have been given a leadership mantle as the President of Ghana. Explain **five** measures you would adopt in promoting national cohesion in the country. [20 marks]

SECTION B

LAW AND ORDER IN THE GHANAIAN SOCIETY AND NATIONALISM AND NATIONHOOD

4. Advocacy and community engagement are powerful tools for inclusive and sustainable development. Examine **five** ways in which the combined effects of advocacy and community engagement can facilitate Ghana's development. [20 marks]
5. (a) State **four** institutions mandated to enforce law and order in the Ghanaian society. [4 marks]
(b) As a concerned citizen of Ghana, examine **four** ways in which inadequate logistics pose a challenge to law enforcement in Ghana. [16 marks]
6. The Judiciary is an integral part of the administration of a country. Evaluate **five** roles the Judiciary plays in overseeing the administrative actions of the executive arm of government. [20 marks]

ETHICS AND HUMAN DEVELOPMENT AND PRODUCTION, EXCHANGE AND CREATIVITY

7. (a) Explain the term *globalization*. [4 marks]
(b) Analyze in **four** ways how globalization is relevant to Ghana's economy. [16 marks]
8. (a) Explain the concept *Budgeting*. [4 marks]
(b) Many individuals struggle with managing their finances effectively and often face financial difficulties. In what **four** ways would *budgeting* be relevant to such individuals? [16 marks]
9. Applying your knowledge of ethics, highlight **five** roles ethical behaviour plays in the development of the individual in society. [20 marks]

END OF PAPER